

JAISON G

Azim Premji, *77*

Founder Chairman, Wipro

Azim Premji will be remembered for the transformation of a vegetable oil company into a consumer goods behemoth. He is also celebrated for the creation of India's largest computer company and second-largest software company—albeit a ranking that has been difficult to sustain. The innovations of Wipro's computer business included the launch of the world's first Multibus II computer, based on the Intel 286 chip, as well as the launch of the Wipro Supergenius personal computer, which became India's largest-selling PC. Premji's software foray charted a path for Indian IT companies to enter the engineering software sector. Wipro led the verticalisation of the computer software sector and the entry of Indian IT firms into the infrastructure support segment. Premji's leadership style was to select leaders he trusted and allow them to make their own decisions.

Kumar Mangalam Birla, *55*

Chairman, Aditya Birla Group

Kumar Mangalam Birla inherited the family business when he was just 28 after his father Aditya Vikram Birla died in 1995. Over the years he has been at the helm, he took the Aditya Birla Group from $2 billion to over $45 billion in revenues. Birla stands out as an exceptional business builder. In 2007, an opportunity arose to bid for the downstream assets of Canadian firm Novelis. Birla saw it as an opportunity to expand the group's global footprint. That decision changed the group's profile and put Hindalco, the group's non-ferrous metals subsidiary, on a verticalisation trajectory. The group now operates across 36 countries. It has a presence in sectors such as carbon black, aluminium, chemicals, pulp, fibre, renewable energy, financial services and textiles. UltraTech is India's largest cement company, while Hindalco Industries is the world's largest flat-rolled product player and recycler of aluminium.



RACHIT GOSWAMI



VIVAN MEHRA

Kiran Mazumdar-Shaw, *69*

Executive Chairperson, Biocon

Kiran Mazumdar-Shaw is a first-generation entrepreneur and global business leader with over four decades of experience in biotechnology. Fuelled by her passion, she started her biotech journey in 1978 from her garage in India. Today, that journey is changing lives for the better across the globe. She is regarded as an unconventional thinker with many firsts to her credit. Under her aegis, Biocon delivers on the promise of making medicines accessible and affordable to millions of patients worldwide. Mazumdar-Shaw is one of India's richest self-made women. The firm has successfully forayed into the lucrative US market. The company has Asia's largest insulin factory in Malaysia's Johor region.